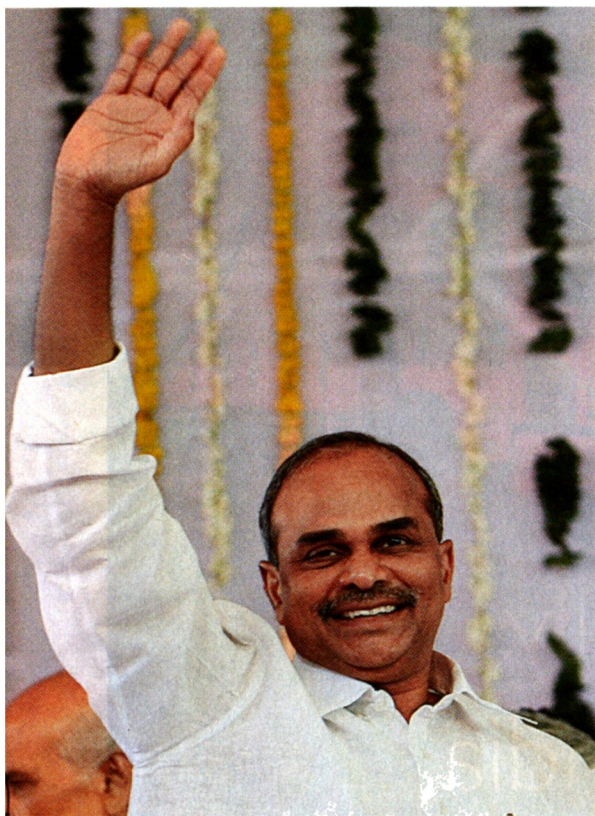


TRANSITIONS

They left us in 2009, but also left behind an indelible memory, a lasting imprint of their lives and the legacy they bequeath



A PRABHAKAR RAO/www.indiatodayimages.com

YSR REDDY (1949-2009)

Of the 14 chief ministers of Andhra Pradesh since 1956, he was the first to die in office—in a helicopter crash. Yedugiri Sandinti Rajasekhara Reddy was a powerful enemy and a valuable ally and truly a man of the people. His most enduring legacy was the drive to provide water to farmers' parched fields. He was singularly responsible for the return of the Congress in the state and the scenes at his funeral bore testimony to his iconic stature and hold on the general population. After his death, YSR's legacy has both the Congress and Andhra Pradesh trapped in turbulence.

He revived the Congress in Andhra Pradesh but left behind a legacy trapped in turbulence.

FEROZ KHAN (1939-2009)

The Clint Eastwood of the East, Khan was the flamboyant style icon of Bollywood. The Afghan debuted in *Didi* in 1960 and appeared in over 50 films during the 1970s and '80s, the most memorable of them being *Qurbani* and *Jaanbaz*. He turned producer in 1971 after playing second lead in a string of movies. In May 2006, he was blacklisted by then Pakistan President Pervez Musharraf when he went there to promote his brother's *Taj Mahal*. His last appearance was in 2007's *Welcome*. He died in his hometown Bangalore.

YOGEN SHAH



KAMALA DAS (1934-2009)

Though her love for poetry started early, she started writing only after she married, writing short stories in Malayalam and poetry in English. She wrote about love, its betrayal and the pain that followed. Her autobiography *My Story* shot her into fame. She was the first to write strongly about women's issues and their frustrations within domestic, wedded lives. Das converted to Islam in 1999 when she was 65 and took the name Kamala Suraiyya.

Das wrote about sexual desires of Indian women, which made her an iconoclast of her generation.